MARTA KOWAL-BRANDT

CI/CD & Kubernetes Engineer | QA Automation Engineer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

QA automation engineer with 7 years of experience, including the last two focused largely on CI/CD pipelines, test environments and build tooling. Hands-on experience with GitLab CI, Docker, Helm and namespace-level Kubernetes deployments, plus personal experience building a k3s cluster and GitOps workflows. Uses Python, Bash and Java for automation and tooling. Currently studying for the Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) exam.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming and scripting: Python, Bash, Java (test code), SQL

Containers and orchestration: Docker, Docker Compose, Kubernetes, k3s, Helm

CI/CD and GitOps: GitLab CI, Jenkins, Argo CD, Git

Infrastructure and operations: Linux, Terraform (personal project), Ansible (basic), Hetzner VPS, AWS (EC2 and S3 basics for learning)

Monitoring and data: Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, PostgreSQL

Testing: pytest, Playwright, Selenium, Postman

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

QA Automation Engineer (Test Infrastructure) *2021–Present*
Odrava Health Software | Wroclaw

- Own GitLab CI pipelines for three product teams (approximately 25 developers), covering build, unit, integration and end-to-end test stages, as well as artifact publishing.
- Reduced average pipeline time from 38 to 14 minutes by parallelising test jobs, caching dependencies and separating end-to-end tests into a dedicated stage; monthly CI runner costs fell by about 30%.
- Built short-lived merge-request test environments using Docker Compose and later Helm on the company's shared Kubernetes cluster. Environments include the application, PostgreSQL and seeded data, and are automatically removed after merge or 48 hours of inactivity.
- Maintain a pytest and Playwright end-to-end suite of approximately 900 tests; reduced the flaky test rate from 7% to below 1%.
- Built test-result collection and Grafana dashboards to help teams identify flaky tests.
- Wrote Bash and Python tools for PostgreSQL test-data seeding and authored an internal guide to the CI system used in team onboarding.
- Work with namespace-level Kubernetes access; the platform team manages the shared cluster.

QA Engineer *2019–2021*
Brightmill Software House | Wroclaw

- Tested web and mobile applications for client projects using manual and automated testing.
- Introduced a Java and Selenium automated regression suite for the largest client project.
- Configured Jenkins jobs to run nightly regression tests.

Customer Support Specialist (2nd line) *2018–2019*
Brightmill Software House | Wroclaw

- Investigated customer issues using logs and databases, and reproduced bugs for developers.

SELECTED PROJECTS

Homelab k3s Cluster with GitOps *2024–2025*
Personal |

- Built a three-node k3s cluster on Raspberry Pi 5 devices, deploying applications from a Git repository with Argo CD.
- Set up Prometheus, Grafana and Loki for monitoring, Traefik ingress and cert-manager for TLS.
- Provisioned infrastructure for a small Hetzner VPS using Terraform.

EDUCATION

BEng, Computer Engineering | Silesian Lowlands University of Technology 2018

CERTIFICATIONS AND PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

ISTQB Foundation Level | 2019
Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) — studying; exam scheduled for January 2027

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

- Mentored two QA interns in 2023
- Participated in two incident calls as an observer; no production on-call responsibility.

LANGUAGES

Polish (native) | English (C1) | German (A2)